

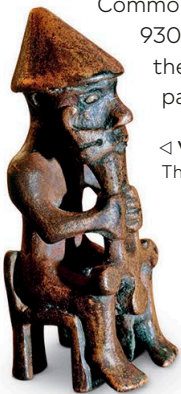
874 CE

ICELAND SETTLED BY VIKINGS

Led by Ingólfur Arnarson, hundreds of Vikings migrated from Scandinavia to Iceland. Thousands more followed in a time known as the landnám ("land-taking"). They soon established farms across the whole island and developed an Icelandic

Commonwealth, governed from 930 CE by the Althing, one of the world's first parliaments.

◁ Viking bronze figure of Thor, Iceland, c.1000

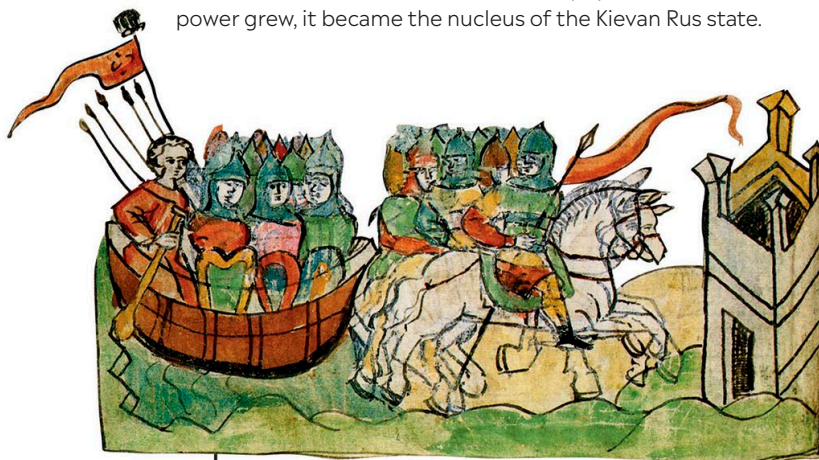


870 CE

c. 882 CE

OLEG, CHIEFTAIN OF THE RUS VIKINGS, BECOMES RULER OF KIEV

Moving from his base around Novgorod, the chieftan Oleg defeated his rivals Askold and Dir and took their stronghold at Kiev. He transferred his capital there, raiding local Slav tribes such as the Drevlians, who he forced to pay tribute. As Kiev's power grew, it became the nucleus of the Kievan Rus state.



△ Oleg of Novgorod in battle

896 CE **Tsar Symeon of Bulgaria** defeats a Byzantine army at Bulgarophyon

878 CE

ALFRED THE GREAT DEFEATS THE VIKINGS

At the Battle of Edington, Alfred saved his Kingdom of Wessex from conquest by the Norse raiders of the Great Heathen Army who had defeated the Anglo-Saxon kingdoms one by one since their arrival in England in 865 CE. The Vikings caught Alfred by surprise, forcing him to flee into marshes around Athelney, but he regrouped and was victorious at Edington, forcing the Vikings to sue for peace.



▷ King Alfred the Great

“The heathen, terrified by hunger, cold, fear, and last of all by despair, begged for peace.”

ASSER, LIFE OF ALFRED, c. 900 CE